



STEFAAN VUYLSTEKE

Profile

Ghent, Belgium

47 years

+20 years experience

Available

Permanent role

3–5 days/week

Mode

Hybrid setup

Office for alignment

Remote for focused work

Contact

+32 484 48 05 24

stefaan@growthup.eu



Explore online

[Relevant projects](#)

[Full career details](#)

Hello SQLI team, let's turn digital strategy into customer growth

SQLI needs a Digital Marketing Strategist who connects strategy, marketing and design, guides specialists and turns client goals into clear digital direction. That fits my background: 20+ years across digital marketing, CRM, marketing automation, CX, research and agency work. I help brands understand users, improve engagement and turn strategy into stronger digital experiences.

● Customer Insights

Qualitative and quantitative research. Behavioural insights and journey mapping translated into lifecycle improvements, better messaging and less friction.

● Data-Driven Engagement

Campaigns built on explicit and implicit data. Advanced segmentation, lead & account scoring, profiling and opt-in strategies to engage the right person at the right moment.

● User Engagement

Research and analytics to understand usage, value, adoption and drop-off, then improve digital products, services and engagement flows so people keep using them.

● UX & UI Thinking

Strong affinity with UX/UI, user journeys and usability research. I work with designers to make digital flows clearer, easier and more useful to users in daily life.

● Customer Engagement

Lead generation, nurture and lifecycle programmes across SaaS, finance and B2B markets. Built rewarded campaigns and flows that improve lead quality, conversion and sales follow-up.

● Testing & Optimisation

UX research, redesign and A/B testing to improve results. Applying Behavioural techniques, detecting digital stress and turning user friction into clearer journeys.

● Marketing Technology

Marketing Automation

Eloqua (Oracle) · Responsys (Oracle) · Marketo (Adobe) · Neolane (Adobe) · Selligent (Zeta) · HubSpot · Pardot (Salesforce) · ExactTarget (Salesforce)

CRM & Reporting

Dynamics 365 (Microsoft) · Sales Cloud (Salesforce) · Siebel (Oracle) · Pipedrive · Teamleader · Tableau (Salesforce) · MicroStrategy

Agency Experience in CX & Digital Marketing

"Agency life suits me: pace, variety, client contact and working with specialists. I like turning strategy, marketing and design into clear plans and delivery."



"SQLI fits because it combines CX, digital transformation, end-to-end delivery and international scale. I help turn strategy into stronger customer experiences."

What makes me a strong fit

● Hands-On

I can think strategically, but also build, fix, document and execute inside existing systems, from brief to delivery and handover.

● Commercial Instinct

I spot client opportunities, guide conversations, propose the next plan and help turn trust and needs into concrete agency business.

● Technology-Driven

CRM, marketing automation, AI, reporting and conversion tech. I assess what creates value and help teams adopt it in real work.

● Agency Experience

10+ years in digital and marketing automation agencies, working with marketing directors, managers and specialists.

● Human Understanding

I ground decisions in real user needs and human behaviour, using evidence to improve digital marketing, services, and engagement.

● Digital Enablement

40+ workshops for marketers and digital teams, from Behaviour design to customer-driven marketing and engagement frameworks.

Industries & brands



"Across industries, I have helped national and international brands use digital to support sales, build stronger customer relationships, improve adoption and usage of digital products and services, and innovate digital services."

Energy & Housing

Eneco, Electrabel, Shell, SSE, Arcadis, Wienerberger, Veolia, Brenntag, Boon Edam, SCIA

Health

Philips Healthcare, Primagaz, CZ, Miss Mira, MenIT, ONVZ, The Breath Club

Telecom & Technology

Telenet, Proximus, Thales, Samsung, Microsoft, Omron, Philips, Wolters Kluwer,

Finance & Retail

Rabobank, Freo, Securex, Euronext, ING, BeoBank, Touring, Nespresso, Auping, ICI Paris XL, Aldi, Exki

Automotive

Audi, VW, BMW, Mini, Skoda, Seat, Porsche, McLaren, Athlon, Mercedes, Honda, Bridgestone

Travel & Media

Thomas Cook, Sunweb, Air Canada, Amadeus, Tohapi, Maxis.ai, DPG Media

Understanding Digital Behavior

I have researched how people use and experience digital products and services across many customer contexts. I look beyond obvious friction: how digital feels in real life, where people hesitate, lose trust or feel overloaded. I use Behavioural insights and techniques to make experiences clearer, more useful and more human when it matters.



Engagement Framework: A framework for how people start, adopt, repeat, return to and expand use of a digital service. It maps value, onboarding, first use, non-use, drop-out, recovery and needed touchpoints.



Experience Context Model: A model that places digital use inside customer experience and real-life context. It links user behaviour with needs, touchpoints, timing, trust and friction beyond the screen.



Human Digital Design Principles. Design principles for real-life goals and constraints, reducing mental load, emotional friction and stress, and making services clear and useful.

What I master

● Digital Marketing Strategy

Owned, paid & earned media | B2B & B2C marketing | Customer & user engagement | Multichannel & automated journeys | From prospect to loyal customer

● Ideation & Concept Designs

Figma | Miro | Ideation | Concept flows | Wireframes | Prototypes | Service improvement | Service innovation | Platforms | Mobile & web apps

● Research & Testing

Qualitative & quantitative research | Market analysis | Behavioural audit | Customer & user profiling | Behaviour change & habits | Contextual mapping

● Digital Design Principles

UX | UI | Usability | Accessibility | WCAG | Design systems | Interaction patterns | UX writing | Error prevention | Human Digital Design principles

● Data & Technology

System integrations | Data flows | Data capture | Form logic | API context | Tracking needs | User access | AI use cases | Privacy & security constraints

● Experimentation & Conversion

A/B testing | Email, website, forms, notifications, landing pages | Personalisation | New technology | Digital stress | Detect & resolve emotional and mental friction | Behavioural techniques

Always people first based on human understanding

My work has always started with people first. Not with channels, features or technology, but with the people using, choosing and experiencing what a business offers. Understanding their context, motivations, behavior and expectations has been a constant throughout my career, with research as a recurring foundation in every role.

My career overview

 [Full career details](#)

Start-ups

Roles:

Industries:

2024 Freelance	The Breath Club Mental & emotional health	Senior Service Designer	
2023 Freelance	Miss Mira AI AI-driven elderly companion	Behavioural Research & Design Consultant	
2023 Freelance	Maxis AI AI-driven travel concierge	Behavioural Research & Design Consultant	
2023 Freelance	Beyonder Behaviour design	Behavioural Research & Design Consultant	
2022 Freelance	Men IT Digital solutions for mental care	Behavioural Research & Service Consultant	

Agencies

Roles:

Industries:

2025 Freelance	Jems Group (Beobank) Data & UX	UX Research Consultant	
2021 Freelance	Serviceplan Group 360° communication	Digital Engagement Consultant	  
2021 Freelance	Springbok Agency Full digital	Strategy Director Service Design & Digital	  
2016 Employee	Engagement Factory Marketing Automation & CX	Customer Experience & Engagement Consultant	     
2014 Employee	Emakina Group Full digital	CRM & Marketing Automation Team Lead	     
2013 Employee	Serviceplan Group 360° communication	CRM & Marketing Automation Team Lead	    
2012 Employee	J. Walter Thompson Full communication	CRM & Marketing Automation Account Manager	 

Corporates

Roles:

Industries:

2024 Freelance	Proximus Telecom	Business & Service Designer	
2021 Freelance	Arcadis Sustainability solutions	Customer Experience & Engagement Consultant	 
2021 Freelance	SCIA SaaS for civil engineering	Customer Experience & Engagement Consultant	 
2020 Freelance	DPG Media Newspapers & magazines	Customer Experience & Lifecycle Consultant	
2019 Freelance	Telenet Business Telecom & technology	Business & Service Designer	 
2015 Employee	Wolters Kluwer Information & software solutions	Marketing Director	 
2008 Employee	Amadeus Travel technology solutions	Customer Segment Manager & Innovation Manager	  
2006 Employee	TNT Group Courier delivery services	Marketing & Product Manager	 
2005 Employee	Princess Home Small household appliances	Retail Marketing Manager	
2003 Employee	Blending International Enterprise software	Customer Segment & CRM Manager	

[Full career details →](#)